

The Cost of Always Being Busy: The First Promise

忙碌的代价：第一次承诺

Theme: 健康、运动与生活习惯 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6,127

English Story

The first promise was made in the clinic canteen, over a **plate** of **salad** and a **bowl** of soup. “Make the **site** accessible, **or** we stop the run,” Maya said. “That is the **immediate** step.” The **custom** in that place was to bring your own **sauce**, and the **sweet vinegar** in a little **jar** became, in their argument, a way of speaking about the **degree** of **trouble** they were in.

The situation was simple: the **incidence** of **ankle** injuries had doubled, the **tray** of bandages was always empty, and the physiotherapist had restricted the training to short sessions. “Take the **wrist** and the **ankle** seriously,” she said. “A **bump** ignored becomes a **deficiency**.” Far from being late, the intervention was exactly on time.

They sent a form to the management and involved the **orchestra** of the sports club in a **formation** that took a **quantitative** view: an **ounce** of prevention, a **pinch** of salt, a **gallon** of water. “Understand the **derivation**,” the coach said. “An **approximation** is not a plan.” The **sticky** floor of the changing room was the first item on the list.

The **interference** came from a **dietary** habit nobody wanted to discuss: the players chewed fast, ate standing, and stopped only when the whistle blew. “**Dumb** animals eat better than we do,” the goalkeeper said, and the **pigeon** on the windowsill agreed. The **ending** of the old diet had to be an **outbreak** of honesty, not a slogan.

The promised improvements were small and regular: a **regularity** of meals, a **disposal** of the old rules, a **shrink** in the menu, and the **flesh** of two oranges a day. “Bring the ladder and take the walk,” Daniel said. “I understand the way now.” It was a **ruinous** habit they were fighting, and they would fight it through an **Olympiad** of small mornings. The fact was that the club had lost **contact** with its own members. An **intrusion** of sponsors into the medical room, a **sweet sauce** on every **plate**, and a **bowl** of **salad** that nobody ate: the culture of the place had to change. “Take the **tray** and send the message,” she said. “Situation by situation, that is the only way.”

中文翻译

第一个承诺是在诊所食堂做出的，面前是一盘沙拉和一碗汤。“把场地变得可达，否则我们就停下这次跑步，”曼雅说，“这就是眼前这一步。”那个地方的习俗是自己带酱汁，而小罐里那点甜醋，在他们的争论中成了谈论自己麻烦程度的一种方式。

处境很简单：脚踝受伤的发生率翻了一倍，绷带托盘总是空的，理疗师把训练限制成了短时段。“把手腕和脚踝当回事，”她说，“被忽视的肿块会变成缺陷。”这次干预远不算晚，恰恰正及时。

他们向管理层寄了一份表格，并让体育俱乐部的管弦乐队以一种定量的阵型参与进来：一盎司预防、一撮盐、一加仑水。“要理解它的推导，”教练说，“近似值不是计划。”更衣室黏糊糊的地板，是清单上的第一项。

干扰来自一个没人愿意谈的饮食习惯：队员嚼得快、站着吃、只在哨响时才停。“哑巴动物吃得比我们好，”守门员说，窗台上的鸽子也同意。旧饮食的终结必须是一场诚实的爆发，而不是一句口号。

承诺的改善既小又有规律：用餐的规律、旧规则的处置、菜单的收缩，以及每天两个橙子的果肉。“把梯子拿来，去走一走，”丹尼尔说，“我现在明白这条路了。”他们要对抗的是一种毁灭性的习惯，而要对抗它，得靠一场由无数个小早晨组成的奥林匹克。事实是，俱乐部已经和自己的成员失去了联系。赞助商闯入医务室，每只盘子上都有一勺甜酱，以及一碗没人吃的沙拉：这个地方的文化必须改变。“把托盘拿起来，把消息发出去，”她说，“一个处境一个处境地来，这是唯一的办法。”

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
or ɒ: POS: conj	conj. 或, 或者; [计] 或 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n a state in northwestern United States on the Pacific; n a room in a hospital equipped for the performance of...
site saɪt POS: n	n. 位置, 场所, 地点; vt. 给...择址 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the piece of land on which something is located (or is to be located); n. physical position in relation to...
degree dɪ'ɡri: POS: n	n. 程度, 度数, 学位, 度; [医] 度, 程度 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a position on a scale of intensity or amount or quality; n. a specific identifiable position in a continuum...
trouble 'trʌbl POS: n	n. 烦恼, 麻烦, 困难, 动乱, 故障; vt. 困扰, 麻烦, 使烦恼, 折磨; vi. 烦恼, 费心 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a source of difficulty; n. an event causing distress or pain; n. an effort that is inconvenient; n. an unwanted...
contact 'kɒntækt POS: n	n. 联系, 交际, 熟人, 接触; vi. 接触, 联系; vt. 使接触 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. close interaction; n. the act of touching physically; n. the state or condition of touching or of being in i...
plate pleɪt POS: n	n. 碟, 盘子, 盆中物, 金属板, 图版, 金银餐具, 印版, 金属牌(照); vt. 镀金, 电镀, 用金属板固定, 给...装钢板, ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a sheet of metal or wood or glass or plastic; n. a full-page illustration (usually on slick paper); n. dish...
immediate ɪ'mi:diət POS: a	a. 立即的, 直接的, 接近的; [医] 直接的, 立即的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. of the present time and place; a. having no intervening medium; s. immediately before or after as in a chain...
sweet swi:t POS: n	n. 甜蜜, 糖果, 情人; a. 甜的, 芳香的, 悦耳的, 漂亮的, 和蔼的, 不咸的, 灵活的, 轻快的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. English phonetician; one of the founders of modern phonetics (1845-1912); n. a food rich in sugar; n. the ta...
bowl bəʊl POS: n	n. 碗, 木球, 大酒杯; v. 滚木球, 快而稳地行驶 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a round vessel that is open at the top; used chiefly for holding food or liquids; ; n. a concave shape with...
formation fɔ:'meɪjən POS: n	n. 形成, 构造, 编队; [医] 形成, 结构 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an arrangement of people or things acting as a unit; n. the act of fabricating something in a particular sh...
restrict rɪ'strɪkt POS: vt	vt. 限制, 限定, 约束; [医] 限制 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. place restrictions on; v. place under restrictions; limit access to; v. place limits on (extent or access)
sauce sɔ:s POS: n	n. 酱油, 调味汁, 酱; vt. 给...调味, 使增加趣味 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. flavorful relish or dressing or topping served as an accompaniment to food; v. behave saucily or impudently...
custom 'kʌstəm POS: n	n. 习惯, 风俗, 海关, 自定义; a. 定制的; [计] 定制; 自定义 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. accepted or habitual practice; n. a specific practice of long standing; n. habitual patronage
salad 'sæləd POS: n	n. 色拉 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. food mixtures either arranged on a plate or tossed and served with a moist dressing; usually consisting of...
flesh 'fleʃ POS: n	n. 肉, 肉体, 肉欲, 人性, 亲属, 人类, 众生, 人体; vt. 以肉喂, 激起...的杀戳情绪, 使肥, 赋以血肉; vi. 长胖 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the soft tissue of the body of a vertebrate: mainly muscle tissue and fat; v. remove adhering flesh from (h...
disposal dɪs'pəʊzəl POS: n	n. 丢掉, 处理, 排列, 销毁, 布置; [医] 处理, 处置 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the power to use something or someone; n. the act or means of getting rid of something; n. a kitchen applan...
wrist rɪst POS: n	n. 手腕, 腕关节; [医] 腕 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a joint between the distal end of the radius and the proximal row of carpal bones
ankle 'æŋkl POS: n	n. 踝; [医] 踝, 踝关节 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a gliding joint between the distal ends of the tibia and fibula and the proximal end of the talus
tray treɪ POS: n	n. 托盘, 公文盘, 满盘, 发射箱; [化] 淋盘 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an open receptacle for holding or displaying or serving articles or food
incidence 'ɪnsɪdəns POS: n	n. 发生, 发生率, 影响, 负担者, 入射, 倾角; [医] 入射, 发生率, 发生数 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the relative frequency of occurrence of something; n. the striking of a light beam on a surface

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orchestra 'ɒ:kɪstrə POS: n	n. 管弦乐队, 乐队演奏处 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a musical organization consisting of a group of instrumentalists including string players; n. seating on th...
jar dʒɑ: POS: n	n. 广口瓶, 震动, 刺耳声; vi. 震惊, 冲突, 发刺耳声, 不一致; vt. 震动, 刺激 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a vessel (usually cylindrical) with a wide mouth and without handles; n. the quantity contained in a jar; v. ...
shrink frɪŋk POS: n	n. 收缩, 萎缩, 回避; vi. 收缩, 退缩, 萎缩, 缩小, 回避; vt. 使收缩, 使缩小 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. reduce in size; reduce physically; v. become smaller or draw together; v. decrease in size, range, or extent
interference ,ɪntə'fɪərəns POS: n	n. 冲突, 干涉; [计] 干扰 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (American football) blocking a player's path with your body
chew tʃu: POS: vt	vt. 咀嚼, 嚼碎; vi. 咀嚼, 细想; n. 咀嚼, 咀嚼物 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a wad of something chewable as tobacco; n. biting and grinding food in your mouth so it becomes soft enough...
dumb dʌm POS: a	a. 哑的, 不说话的, 无声音的; [医] 哑的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. lacking the power of human speech; s. unable to speak because of hereditary deafness
outbreak 'aʊtbreɪk POS: n	n. 爆发, 暴动; [医] 暴发 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a sudden violent spontaneous occurrence (usually of some undesirable condition)
vinegar 'vɪnɪɡə POS: n	n. 醋, 尖酸刻薄; vt. 加醋于 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. sour-tasting liquid produced usually by oxidation of the alcohol in wine or cider and used as a condiment...
ending 'endɪŋ POS: n	n. 终止, 终了, 收场; [医] 末梢 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the end of a word (a suffix or inflectional ending or final morpheme); n. event whose occurrence ends somet...
deficiency dɪ'fɪjənsɪ POS: n	n. 缺乏, 不足; [医] 缺乏, 不足 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n the state of needing something that is absent or unavailable; n lack of an adequate quantity or number
bump bʌmp POS: n	n. 撞击, 肿块; vt. 碰撞; vi. 撞, 颠簸而行 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a lump on the body caused by a blow; v. knock against with force or violence; v. dance erotically or dance w...
gallon 'gælən POS: n	n. 加仑; [医] 加仑 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. United States liquid unit equal to 4 quarts or 3.785 liters; n. a British imperial capacity measure (liquid...
sticky 'stɪki POS: a	a. 粘的, 有粘性的, 顽固的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. moist as with undried perspiration and with clothing sticking to the body; s. covered with an adhesive mate...
pigeon 'pɪdʒɪn POS: n	n. 鸽子, 易上当受骗的人, 年轻女子 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. wild and domesticated birds having a heavy body and short legs
quantitative 'kwɒntɪtətɪv POS: a	a. 数量的, 定量的; [医] 定量的, 数量的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. expressible as a quantity or relating to or susceptible of measurement; a. relating to the measurement of q...
dietary 'daɪetəri POS: a	a. 饮食的; n. 规定食物 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a regulated daily food allowance; a. of or relating to the diet
intrusion ɪn'tru:ʒən POS: n	n. 闯入, 侵扰; [医] [向内]突入 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. entrance by force or without permission or welcome; n. the forcing of molten rock into fissures or between...
pinch pɪntʃ POS: n	n. 捏, 拧, 撮, 少量, 收缩, 挤压, 夹痛, 苦恼, 逮捕, 指控, 匮乏, 紧急关头; vt. 捏, 拧, 掐, 挤压, 修剪, ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a painful or straitened circumstance; n. an injury resulting from getting some body part squeezed; n. a sque...
ounce aʊns POS: n	n. 盎司, 少量, 雪豹; [医] 英两, ㄱ Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a unit of apothecary weight equal to 480 grains or one twelfth of a pound; n. a unit of weight equal to one...
bandage 'bændɪdʒ POS: n	n. 绷带; [化] 帘布筒; 实心轮胎; 紧带; 绷带 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a piece of soft material that covers and protects an injured part of the body; v. dress by covering or bind...
regularity ,regjʊ'lærɪti POS: n	n. 规则性, 匀整, 正规, 经常; [医] 规律性 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a property of polygons: the property of having equal sides and equal angles; n. the quality of being charac...

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approximation ə.pɹɒksɪ'meɪʃən POS: n	n. 接近, 近似值; [医] 接近; 近似 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the quality of coming near to identity (especially close in quantity); n. an imprecise or incomplete account...
derivation ˌderɪ'veɪʃən POS: n	n. 推论, 推导, 来历; [医] 衍化, 诱导 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the source or origin from which something derives (i.e. comes or issues); n. a line of reasoning that shows...
ruinous 'ruɪnəs POS: a	a. 破坏性的, 招致毁灭的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s extremely harmful; bringing physical or financial ruin; s causing injury or blight; especially affecting with...
Olympiad əʊ'lɪmpɪəd POS: n	n. (四年一次的) 奥林匹克世界运动大会, 四年周期 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. one of the four-year intervals between Olympic Games; used to reckon time in ancient Greece for twelve centuries...